

Jürgen Klopp

**102 Passing,
Counter-pressing
Possession Games,
Speed & Warm-ups
Direct from Klopp's
Training Sessions**

Vol. 1



JÜRGEN KLOPP

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PUBLISHED BY



CONTENTS

Jürgen Klopp's Achievements	8
Klopp's Trophies and Records at Liverpool	9
Jürgen Klopp's Philosophy: Best Quotes	11
Diagram Key	12
Practice Format	12
Liverpool Pre-Match Warm-up	13
Part 1/6. Individual Exercises and Passing in Groups.....	14
Part 2/6. Group Activation Exercises	15
Part 3/6. Functional Movements + Sprints.....	16
Part 4/6. Passing in Pairs	17
Part 5/6. 4 v 4 (+2) End to End Possession Game.....	18
Part 6/6. "3-Ball" Finishing Drill + Short Sharp Sprints	19
Pre-season Training	20
1. Receive, Turn, Feint, Dribble & Pass in an End to End Technical Practice.....	21
2. Pass and Score Quickly vs. Speed of Middle Player Game	22
3. Juggle, Pick-up Bibs + First to Score in a Speed Race Game	23
4. Pass, Receive, and Dribble in a Double Triangle Connected Circuit.....	24
5. One-Twos on the Run in a Double Triangle Connected Circuit	25
6. Pass and Move to Receive, Dribble Through Poles + Target Goal	26
7. Pre-season Passing Circuit with One-Twos + Pass into Target Goal.....	27
8. Various Attacking Combinations in Threes with the Coach's Signal	28
Warm-up Exercises WITHOUT a Ball.....	29
1. Mobility Warm-up Circuit with Stretching + Speed & Agility Work (1)	30
2. Mobility Warm-up Circuit with Stretching + Speed & Agility Work (2)	31
3. Speed Warm-up Circuit + Static Stretching.....	32

4. Speed Warm-up with Quick Feet + Physical Duel	33
5. Coordination Warm-up with Dynamic Jumps and Movements	34
6. Dynamic Warm-up Circuit with All Types of Movements & Obstacles	35

Warm-up Exercises WITH a Ball

1. Technical Ball Control Warm-up with Various Stations	37
2. Speed of Movement Warm-up with Volleys and Headers	38
3. Dynamic Movements, Speed and Quick One-Twos Warm-up Circuit	39
4. Warm-up Competition Game with Speed, Pass, Receive + Shoot	40
5. Juggling Challenger 3-Round Relay Game (Individual, Pairs and Fours)	41
6. Football Tennis Game with Maximum of 3 Touches and 1 Bounce	42
7. Double Triangle 2-Touch Passing Warm-up	43

Speed & Agility

1. Fast Reactions to Coach's Signal in a Quick Feet + Sprint Race	45
2. Fast Reactions to "Left or Right" Signal to Drop Back + Sprint Race	46
3. Fast Reactions to Multiple Signals in a Speed of Movement Race	47
4. Fast Side-to-Side Reactions with Mannequins, Turn + Sprint Race	48
5. Fast Side-to-Side Reactions to Sound & Visual Signals + Sprint Race	49
6. Fast Turns, Awareness & Changes of Direction + Sprint Race	50
7. React to Signal + Sprint in 1v1 Duel	51
8. Physical Duel, React to Signal + Sprint Race	52
9. Quick Turns, React to Signal + Sprint Race to Finish Line	53
10. Rotate Position, React to Signal + Sprint Race	54
11. Spin, React to Signal + Sprint Race to Finish	55
12. Speed, Coordination & Agility Race with Signaled Fast Reactions	56
13. Speed, Coordination & Agility Circuit with Sprints	57
14. Quick Steps, Changes of Direction and Short Sprints	58
15. Quick Steps, Slalom, Plyometric Exercises & Agility Circuit	59
16. Agility Circuit with Plyometric Exercises for Speed & Explosiveness	60
17. Fast Feet, Sprints, Plyometric Exercises & Jumps in a Speed Circuit	61



Passing Combinations	62
1. One-Two, Pass and Move 3-Player Support Play Combinations	64
2. One-Two, Pass and Move 4-Player Support Play Combinations	65
3. Lofted Passing with 2-Pairs (Pass and Receive)	66
4. Passing in Fours + Quick Change of Direction to Go in Behind	67
5. Two-Touch (Pass and Receive) Triangle	68
6. Support Play and Timing of Movement Triangle with One-Twos	69
7. Central Support, Diagonal Pass, Receive and Dribble in a Triangle	70
8. Double Triangle Link Support Play in a "Passing Y"	71
9. Pass, Press, and Rotate in a 2-Ball Passing Diamond	72
10. One-Twos and Third Man Run Combinations with Switch of Play	73
11. Third Man Run Combinations + Give & Go Passing Circuit	74
12. Two-Touch "Double Triangle" Passing Circuit	75
13. Two-Touch "Double Triangle" Passing Circuit with One-Two	76
14. Open Up to Support in a Multi-Direction Passing Square	77
15. Diagonal Passes and Support Play Movements to Left and Right	78
16. Receive on Half-Turn + Diagonal Pass	79
17. Receive on Half-Turn, Diagonal Pass + One-Two	80
18. Double One-Two + Pass in Mini Goal	81
19. Quick One-Twos and Timing of Support + Switch of Pass	82
20. Give & Go + Switch in Two Connected Passing Squares	83
21. Short One-Twos in a "Double Square" with Central Support Play	84
22. Breaking the Lines with Angled Support, Lay-offs and Forward Runs	85
23. Breaking the Lines with Angled Support, Lay-offs + Third Man Run	86
24. Passing and Support Play with Quick Rotations and Movements	87
Pattern Example 1: Receive OUTSIDE 4 Box Mannequins First	87
Pattern Example 2: Receive INSIDE 4 Box Mannequins First	88
25. Short Possession Play + Change Direction with Sprints to Support	89
26. Possession Play + Quick Transition to Score with New Ball	90
27. Possession Play + Quick Transition to Score in Target Goals	91

Passing Diamond Combinations	92
1. Diamond with Give & Go, Switch, One-Two + Through Pass	93
2. Diamond with One-Two, Lay-offs, Give & Go + Through Pass	94
3. Diamond with One-Two, Lay-off + Final Switch Pass	95
4. Diamond with Short Combination Play + Final Switch Pass	96
5. Diamond with One-Two, Pass, One-Two, Pass	97
6. Diamond with One-Two, Give & Go + Final Pass for Third Man Run	98
7. Diamond with One-Two + Two Give & Goes	99
8. Diamond with One-Two, Lay-off, Switch + Give & Go	100
9. Diamond with Central Link Player: One-Twos & Opening Up to Receive	101
10. Diamond with Central Link Player: Lay-offs and Support Play	102
11. Diamond with Central Link Player: Support Play for Give & Goes	103
12. Diamond with Central Link Player: Support Play to Left and Right Sides	104
13. Diamond + Triangle with Quick Changes of Direction	105
14. Diamond + Triangle with Short and Quick Combination Play	106
 Jürgen Klopp's Pressing and Counter-pressing Philosophy	107
Pressing and Counter-Pressing	108
Jürgen Klopp's Counter-Pressing	109
Pressing and Counter-Pressing Focus in Liverpool's Training	110
 Pressing Rondos and Possession Games	111
1. 4v2 Rondo to Find the Free Player and Pressing to Close Passing Lines	113
2. 4v2 Pressing Rondo +1 Middle Floating Player	114
3. 5v2 Intense Pressing Rondo to "Win the Ball within 6 Passes"	115
4. Transition from Attack to Defence in Simultaneous 5v2 Rondos	116
5. 6v2 Rondo to Find the Free Player and Pressing to Close Passing Lines	117
6. 6v2 End to End Rondo with Support Play and Constant Pressing	118
7. 4-Team 2 + 2 + 2 v 2 Rondo with Fast Pressing and Transitions	119
8. 7v7 Pole Gates Possession Game	120
9. 7v7 Pole Gates Possession Game with End Zone Players	121

Pressing and Counter-pressing Rondos and Possession Games	122
1. "Hunt the Ball" 3 (+3) v 3 Tactical Rondo to Train Counter-pressing	124
2. High Intensity 3 (+2) v 3 Pressing & Counter-pressing Possession Game	125
3. 4 (+2) v 4 Pressing & Counter-pressing Possession Game	126
4. 4 (+2) v 4 Possession Game with Intense Counter-pressing Focus	127
5. 3 (+2) v 3 (+2) Possession Game with "Free" Outside Support Players	128
6. High Intensity Pressing 4 (+2) v 4 Possession Game in Centre Circle	129
7. High Intensity Pressing 4 (+3) v 4 Possession Game in Centre Circle	130
8. Support Play + Continuous Pressing 4 (+6) v 4 Hexagon Possession Game.	131
9. Pressing & Counter-pressing in a 3-Team 4 (+4) v 4 Possession Game	132
10. Dynamic 4 v 4 v 4 Three-Zone End to End Possession Game	133
11. Pressing and Counter-pressing in a 4 (+3) v 4 Positional Possession Game	134
12. Pressing and Counter-pressing in a 4 (+4) v 4 Positional Possession Game	135
13. Pressing and Counter-pressing in a 7 (+3) v 7 Positional Possession Game	136

JÜRGEN KLOPP'S ACHIEVEMENTS



COACHING ROLES

- **Liverpool F.C.** (2015 - Present)
- **Borussia Dortmund** (2008-2015)
- **Mainz 05** (2001 - 2008)

HONOURS (Europe/World)

- **UEFA Champions League** (2019)
- **UEFA Champions League Runner-up** (2013 & 2018)
- **UEFA Europa League Runner-up** (2016)
- **FIFA Club World Cup** (2019)
- **UEFA Super Cup** (2019)

HONOURS (Domestic Leagues)

- **English Premier League** (2020)
- **German Bundesliga x 2** (2011 & 2012)

HONOURS (Domestic Cups)

- **English FA Cup** (2022)
- **EFL Cup** (2022)
- **German DFB-Pokal** (2012)
- **German DFL-Supercup** (2013 & 2014)

INDIVIDUAL AWARDS

- **The Best FIFA Men's Coach** (2019 & 2020)
- **Onze d'Or Coach of the Year** (2019)
- **IFFHS World's Best Club Coach** (2019)
- **World Soccer Awards World Manager of the Year** (2019)
- **Premier League Manager of the Season** (2020)
- **LMA Manager of the Year** (2020)
- **BBC Sports Personality of the Year Coach Award** (2019)
- **German Football Manager of the Year** (2011, 2012 & 2019)

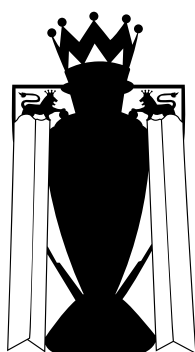
KLOPP'S TROPHIES AND RECORDS AT LIVERPOOL

2018-2019



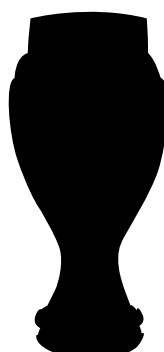
UEFA Champions League

2019-2020



Premier League

+



UEFA Super Cup

+



FIFA Club World Cup

In the 2018-2019 season, Jürgen Klopp's Liverpool team won the **UEFA Champions League** and also came close to winning the Premier League, finishing with a record breaking runner-up total of 97 points (losing only 1 game), just 1 point short of champions Manchester City. To win the UEFA Champions League, Liverpool beat **Bayern Munich, Porto, FC Barcelona, and Tottenham** with high intensity, attacking and exciting football.

In the 2019-2020 season, Jürgen Klopp's Liverpool team won the **UEFA Super Cup**, the **FIFA World Club Cup**, and the **Premier League** title with 7 games still to be played and another incredible points total of 99. Across these 2 Premier League seasons (2018/2019 & 2019/2020), Klopp's Liverpool had a record of 62 wins, 10 draws and only 4 losses (of which 2 losses were after they were already crowned Premier League Champions in 2020).

Jürgen Klopp's Liverpool have also achieved the following league records:

- Joint-record for **most Premier League wins in a season (32)** - 2019/2020.
- February 2019 to July 2020, Liverpool **won 24 consecutive Premier League home matches**.
- Joint-record for **most Premier League home wins in a season (18)** - 2019/2020.
- Joint-record for **fewest Premier League home defeats in a season (0)** - 2018/2019 and 2019/2020.
- October 2019 to February 2020, Liverpool **won 18 consecutive league matches**, a joint-record in English top-flight history.
- Liverpool remained **undefeated in 68 consecutive league games at home** (April 2017 - January 2021) - the third longest run in English top-flight history.

* Trophy images from **PIXSECTOR.com**

2021-2022



FA Cup

+



EFL Cup

In the 2021-2022 season, Jürgen Klopp's Liverpool team won the **FA Cup** and **EFL Cup** double, beating a strong Chelsea team in both finals.

They also came close to winning the Premier League again, finishing with another incredible total of 92 points after losing only 2 games, just 1 point short of champions Manchester City.



* Trophy images from **PIXSECTOR.COM**

JÜRGEN KLOPP'S PHILOSOPHY: BEST QUOTES

"Attack the opponent with, but especially without the ball - a chasing attitude over 95 minutes."

"Our way of playing is the central element in our training sessions."

"We have a team of 11 at a time, each of whom is an attacking forward and each of whom is a defender."

"We want to attack the opponent non-stop - when we have the ball, when we lose it and when the opposition have it."



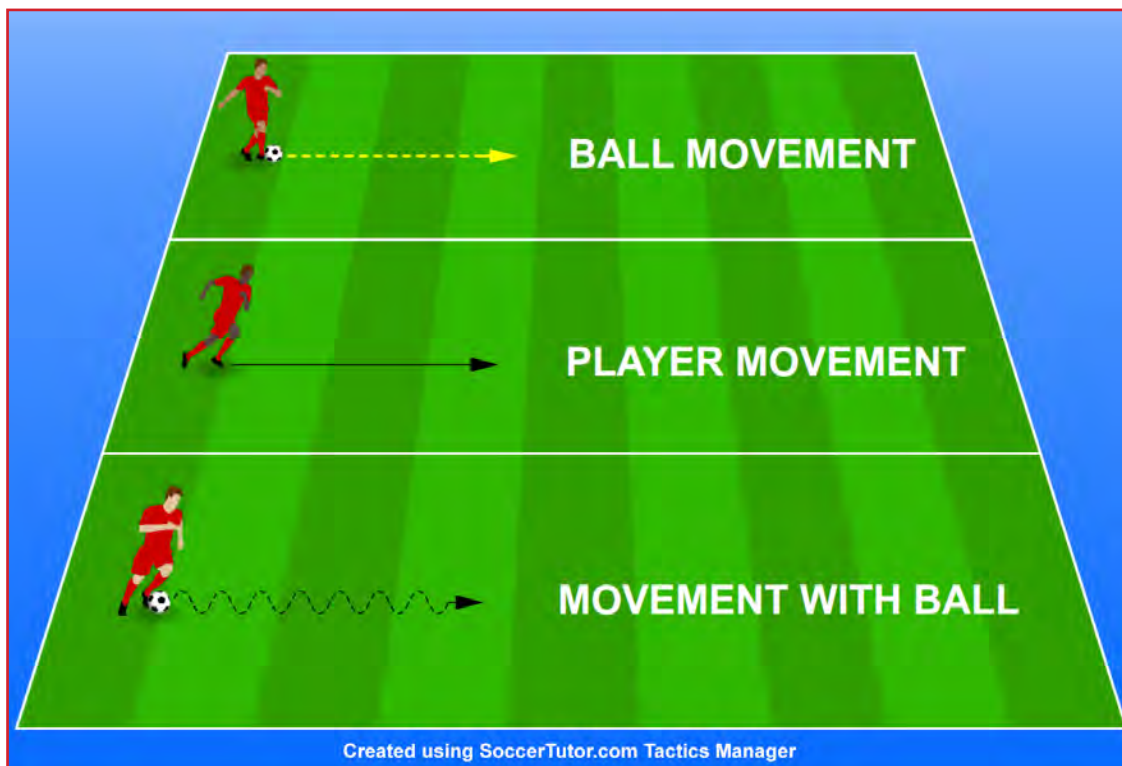
"Fighting football, not serenity football - that is what I like."

"With a few new movements, with a few new passing options, you can change the whole game."

"He [Arsene Wenger] likes having the ball, playing football, passes. It's like an orchestra. But it's a silent song. I like heavy metal."

"Coaches will say that it's not important for their team to run more, and they prefer to make games the right way. I want to make games only the right way and run 10km more."

DIAGRAM KEY



PRACTICE FORMAT

- The practices in this book are direct from Jürgen Klopp's training sessions at Liverpool F.C. between 2017 and 2022.
- Each practice includes the practice topic/name and clear diagrams with a detailed description.

Pre-season Training



Direct from
Jürgen Klopp's
Training Sessions

7. Pre-season Passing Circuit with One-Twos + Pass into Target Goal



Practice Description

1. **A** passes to **B** (either side).
2. **B** returns the pass to **A**, who moves forward to receive and complete the one-two.
3. **A** passes diagonally to **C** (or **C2** if playing from other side), who checks and drops back/inside to receive.
4. **C** plays the ball back for **B** to receive on the run.
5. **B** passes diagonally to **C2**, who moves in front of the mannequin.
6. **C2** plays the ball for **C** to receive on the run.
7. **C** delivers the final pass timed for **C2's** run around the mannequin.
8. **C2** scores in the mini goal.
9. The players rotate to the next position (**A** → **B** → **C** → **C2** → **A**) and the practice continues.

Source: Jürgen Klopp's Liverpool training session at Ramon Sanchez-Pizjuan Stadium, Seville - July 2017

Warm-up Exercises WITH a Ball



Direct from
Jürgen Klopp's
Training Sessions

3. Dynamic Movements, Speed and Quick One-Twos Warm-up Circuit



Practice Description

1. From Point A, perform leg kicks through the 3 poles.
2. Quick touches of the ball with the inside or soles of the feet (side-to-side).
3. Jog to the mannequin.
4. The coach feeds the ball on the ground on one side of the mannequin for a pass back, and then repeats to the other side (2 x one-twos).
5. The players jog to Point B.
6. Lateral steps through the 4 cones.
- 7-9. Repeat steps 2, 3, and 4.
10. Jog to the pole.
11. Run around the pole, move backwards to cone and then forwards. Repeat with the next pole.
12. Leave the area and jog to Point A to continue the circuit.

Source: Jürgen Klopp's Liverpool training session at AXA Training Centre, Liverpool - December 2021

Speed & Agility



Direct from
Jürgen Klopp's
Training Sessions

9. Quick Turns, React to Signal + Sprint Race to Finish Line



The practice started off simply by sprinting and touching the mannequins + sprint to finish, but progressed to include turns, which is fully described in the description.

Practice Description

1. One player from each group starts on either side of the area facing each other. The Coach calls out "Turn."
2. The players turn around 180°.
3. The Coach calls out "Turn" again.
4. The players turn around 180° again.
5. The Coach calls out "Yellow" or "Red."
6. The players quickly sprint and touch that colour mannequin (yellow in diagram).
7. The 2 players complete the sequence by turning and racing to the opposite finish line - fastest wins!
8. The next 2 players enter to compete against each other, and the practice continues.

Source: Jürgen Klopp's Liverpool training session at AXA Training Centre, Liverpool - September 2021

Passing Combinations



Direct from
Jürgen Klopp's
Training Sessions

"With a few new movements, with a few new passing options, you can change the whole game."



24. Passing and Support Play with Quick Rotations and Movements



Pattern Example 1: Receive OUTSIDE 4 Box Mannequins First

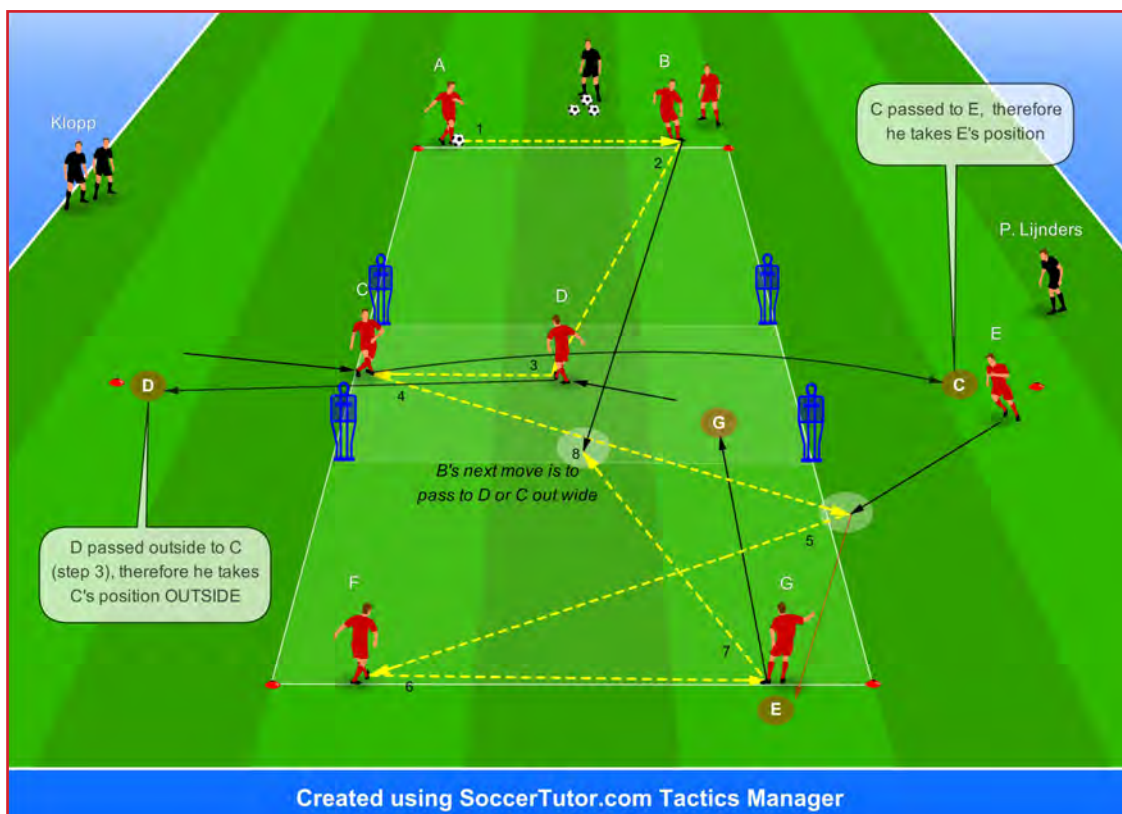


Practice Description

1. **A** passes to **B**.
2. **B** passes to **C**, who is positioned OUTSIDE of the 4 box mannequins by the wide cone. He can choose to receive INSIDE too (see next page).
3. **C** passes to **D**, who moves across from the other side to provide support.
4. **D** sets the ball back for the advancing **B**.
5. **B** passes out wide and in front of the mannequin for the forward run of **E**.
6. **E** passes diagonally to **F**.
7. **F** passes across to **G**.
8. **G** passes to **D**, who is now positioned OUTSIDE of the 4 box mannequins.
- 9-10. **D** passes inside to **C**, and **C** sets the ball back for **G** or turns and passes to **B**.

Source: Jürgen Klopp's Liverpool training session at AXA Training Centre, Liverpool - July 2022

Pattern Example 2: Receive INSIDE 4 Box Mannequins First



Practice Description

1. **A** passes to **B**.
2. **B** passes to **D**, who is positioned INSIDE in the middle of the 4 box mannequins. He can choose to receive OUTSIDE too (see previous page).
3. **D** passes to **C**, who moves inside from outside to provide support.
4. **C** passes out wide and in front of the mannequin for the forward run of **E**.
5. **E** passes diagonally to **F**.
6. **F** passes across to **G**.
7. **G** passes to **B**, who has moved INSIDE of the 4 box mannequins.

8. **B** decides to pass out wide and in front of the mannequin for the forward run of either **D** or **C**.

Player Movements

- The players are able to choose whether they move INSIDE or OUTSIDE first (to receive pass from Player B).
- The players' movements after their passes are clearly displayed in both diagrams.

Variation

- Coach P. Lijnders adds one-two combinations.

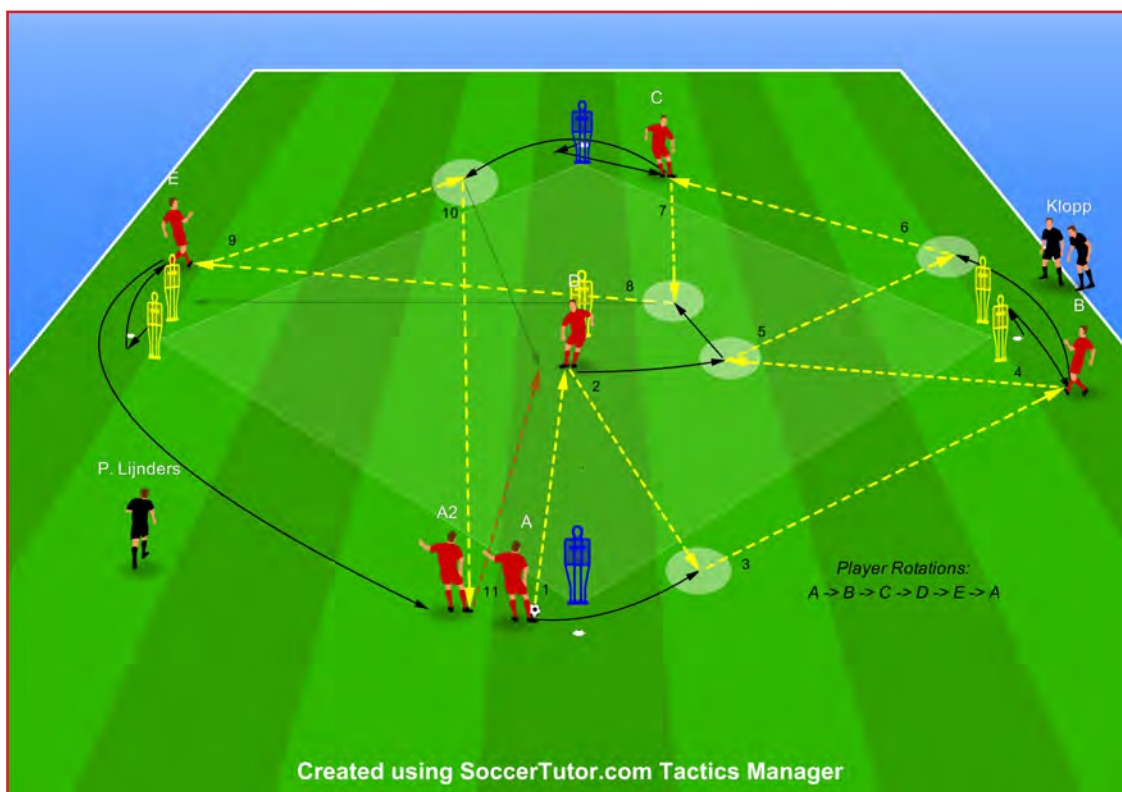
Source: Jürgen Klopp's Liverpool training session at AXA Training Centre, Liverpool - July 2022

Diamond Passing Combinations



Direct from
Jürgen Klopp's
Training Sessions

10. Diamond with Central Link Player: Lay-offs and Support Play



All players check away off their cone before moving to receive and rotate their positions:

A → B → C → D → E → A2.

Practice Description

1. **A** passes to the middle player **D**.
2. **D** passes back to **A**, who moves around the mannequin to receive.
3. **A** passes to **B**.
4. **B** passes inside to the middle player **D**.
5. **D** passes back to **B**, who moves around

the 2 mannequins to receive the return pass.

6. **B** passes to **C**.
7. **C** sets the ball back for **D**.
8. **D** passes across to **E**.
9. **E** sets the ball back for **C**'s movement around the mannequin.
10. **C** passes to **A2**, who starts the next repetition of the same sequence.

Source: Jürgen Klopp's Liverpool training session at Melwood Training Ground, Liverpool - March 2017

Jürgen Klopp's Pressing and Counter-pressing Philosophy



Direct from
Jürgen Klopp's
Training Sessions

PRESSING AND COUNTER-PRESSING

PRESSING

Pressing is when pressure is applied by the defending team on a player or team that has possession of the ball.

Pressing is used to rush the opponent's next action and limit the time and space available for good decision making.

The aim is to force the ball away from dangerous areas and win the ball from your opponents.

However, pressing is not only a defensive tactic used to stop your opponent from creating chances and scoring goals.

Pressing, counter-pressing and counter attacks provide defending and attacking tactics for a team, with the aim to apply pressure, win the ball and then launch a quick counter attack to score.

The higher a team recovers possession, the nearer the opposition goal is and the faster the ball is recovered after its loss.

In addition, the opposition may be unbalanced with limited time to cover space, which leaves gaps and lines available. In this way, counter attacks become a natural consequence of ball recovery.

COUNTER-PRESSING

Immediate pressing around the ball area just after losing possession to win the ball back as quickly as possible.

By using counter-pressing, your team are pressing a transition from defence to attack or counter attack from the opposition without retreating back, thus stopping their attack before it starts.

Counter-pressing Tactics

1. Overload the space around the ball.
2. Press the ball carrier while he is receiving and/or controlling the ball with one or two players.
3. Block passing lines for potential receivers.
4. Be compact around the ball area.
5. Try to force a mistake or at least force the play wide.

JÜRGEN KLOPP'S COUNTER-PRESSING

Jürgen Klopp: "The best moment to win the ball is immediately after your team just lost it. The opponent is still looking for orientation where to pass the ball. He will have taken his eyes off the game to make his tackle or interception and he will have expended energy. Both make him vulnerable."

JÜRGEN KLOPP'S COUNTER-PRESSING

Liverpool are and have been the best counter-pressing team in world football for a few years.

Jürgen Klopp wants his players to:

1. Play with a high defensive line.
2. Play with a high intensity.
3. Play with a fast and exciting all-action attacking style.
4. Attack the space in front after losing the ball (aggressive counter-pressing).
5. Surround the man with the ball.
6. Win the ball back as quickly as possible!

Jürgen Klopp explains that:

"The closest player goes 100% and puts total effort into the press."

"One player can always defend two opponents by blocking the line, pressing the ball carrier and checking over the shoulder."

"The last two yards of the press define everything. As far as aggression goes, yes please, but this must be controlled with

an anticipation of where the next pass will go, and with teammates reorganising as a group constantly and quickly."

BENEFITS OF LIVERPOOL'S COUNTER-PRESSING STYLE

1. Regaining possession high up the pitch.
2. Gaps in opposition's disorganised shape can be exploited.
3. More chances created as they are closer to the opposition's goal.
4. More goals scored!
5. Continuously win the ball back quickly = longer spells of possession.
6. Stop the opposition from having successful counter attacks.
7. Improve work rate, teamwork and motivation for the whole team with a very positive style of play (on the front foot).
8. Excite the crowd and create high energy, engagement and noise to encourage the team further.

PRESSING AND COUNTER-PRESSING FOCUS IN LIVERPOOL'S TRAINING

Jürgen Klopp: "We want to attack the opponent non-stop when we have the ball, when we lose it and when the opposition have it."

RONDOS

The emphasis of Rondos is normally expected to be about possession, but at Klopp's Liverpool the focus is on pressing and counter-pressing.

As Klopp has talked about, defending is Liverpool's first attacking action. Their playing style is with a high line and pressing with high intensity to win the ball as quickly as possible.

Klopp's Assistant Coach Pep Lijnders has explained how rondos and possession games are all about pressing in Liverpool training sessions, explaining that they must "stimulate our counter-pressing vision where we try to disrupt the build-up of the opponent inside their first few touches."

When referring to the Rondos which are part of all of Liverpool's training sessions, Pep Lijnders remarks that the 5v2 rondo is a **Pressing Rondo**. He goes on to say:

"Our game is about movement and speed, and with only five players, those five have to run non-stop."

"The two guys in the middle are encouraged to intercept within the first six passes. If they succeed, they can both go out at the same time. Otherwise, only the player who intervened is allowed to leave the middle."

POSSESSION GAMES

Liverpool's possession games are focused on immediate fast transitions and making sure to never pause or delay after losing the ball, even for a second.

Pep Lijnders explains that "The players first have to understand the importance of counter-pressing to our team - that element comes back in every exercise."

"When a team lose the ball in training, you will hear me, Jürgen or Pete (Krawietz) screaming: 'Go! Get it back! Don't stop!'"

When observing Liverpool's rondos and possession games in their training sessions, the following is clear:

- The players keep count of the passes to maintain a high level of competition.
- In the rondos, the motivation to win the ball within 6 passes increases the speed and intensity of the pressing to replicate Liverpool's non-stop running counter-pressing philosophy.
- The Liverpool players react immediately to press the new ball carrier.
- The Liverpool coaches and players really focus on the counter-press, to act collectively as a team and try to win the ball back immediately after losing possession.

Pep Lijnders Quotes from: Renard, A - The Guardian. 2019. Interview with Liverpool's Pep Lijnders [Online]. [Accessed 30th October].

Available from: <https://www.theguardian.com/football/2019/dec/02/liverpool-pep-lijnders-jurgen-klopp-assistant-paddle-tennis-james-milner>

Pressing Rondos and Possession Games



Direct from
Jürgen Klopp's
Training Sessions

**"Attack the opponent
with, but especially
without the ball - a chasing
attitude over 95 minutes."**



7. 4-Team 2+2+2 v 2 Rondo with Fast Pressing and Transitions



Practice Description

- In this 6v2 Rondo (2+2+2 v 2), the players work in groups of 8 in a 10 yard square. There are 4 teams of 2 players
- There are 2 players on 2 sides of the square and 1 player on the other 2 sides. They are positioned on the outsides but must still play within the area.
- The 6 outside players (3 teams of 2) aim to keep possession of the ball and are only allowed to use **1 touch**.
- The 2 inside players work together to press, close the angles for the potential passing lines and win the ball.
- **RULE:** If the defending team win the ball, they switch roles with the team that lost it and move to the outside. The team that lost the ball become the defending team in the middle.

Source: Jürgen Klopp's Liverpool training session at AXA Training Centre, Liverpool - October 2021

Pressing and Counter-pressing Rondos and Possession Games

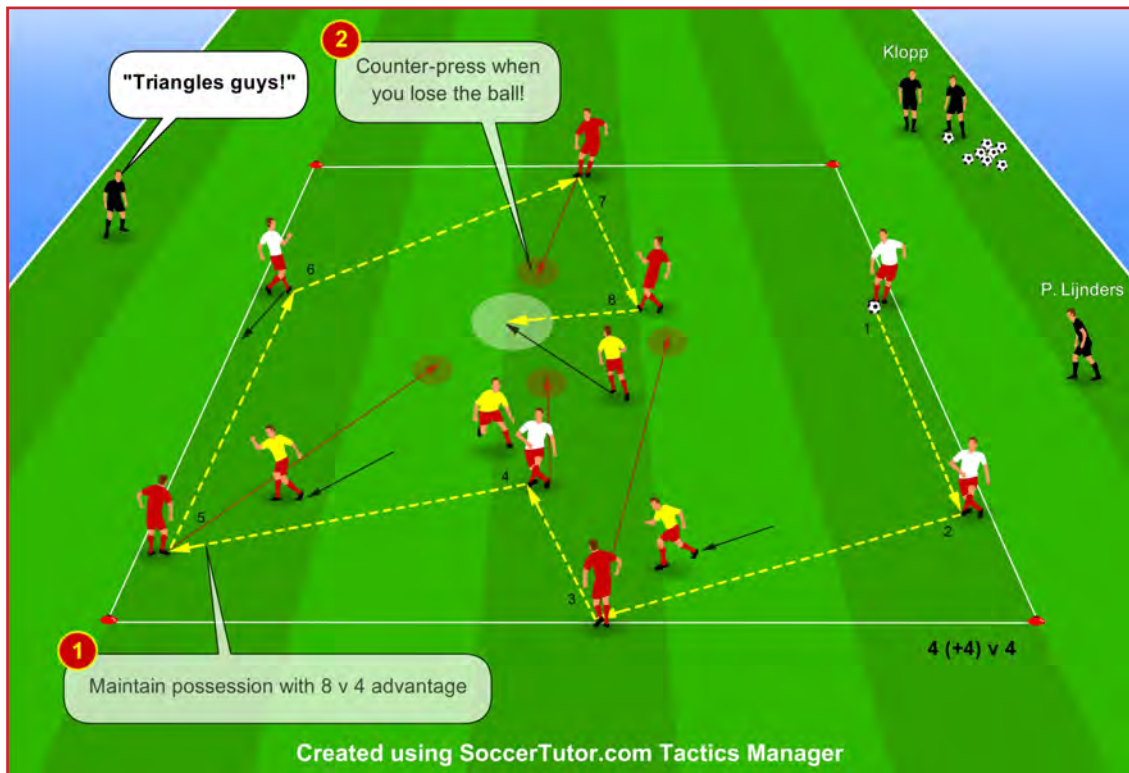


Direct from
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Training Sessions

"The best moment to win the ball is immediately after your team just lost it. The opponent is still looking for orientation where to pass the ball. He will have taken his eyes off the game to make his tackle or interception and he will have expended energy. Both make him vulnerable."



9. Pressing & Counter-pressing in a 3-Team 4 (+4) v 4 Possession Game



Practice Description

- In a 10 yard square, there are 3 teams of 4 players (red, white, and yellow). 2 teams start in possession with 3 outside players and 1 inside player each. The other team defends with all 4 players operating inside the area.
- The players mostly use **1 or 2 touches**.
- The 4 defending players (yellows in diagram) work together to press, block off passing lines and try to win the ball.
- The reds and whites look to move the ball quickly and maintain possession. If the defending team win the ball, they switch roles with the team that lost it.
- In this example, the yellows win the ball, switch roles with the reds and try to keep possession with the whites. The reds must react very quickly to try and win the ball back (**counter-press!**).
- **COACHING POINT:** The coach's focus is triangle shapes in possession and the counter-press, for the outside players to compress quickly and win the ball back immediately after losing the ball.

Source: Jürgen Klopp's Liverpool training session at AXA Training Centre, Liverpool - July 2022

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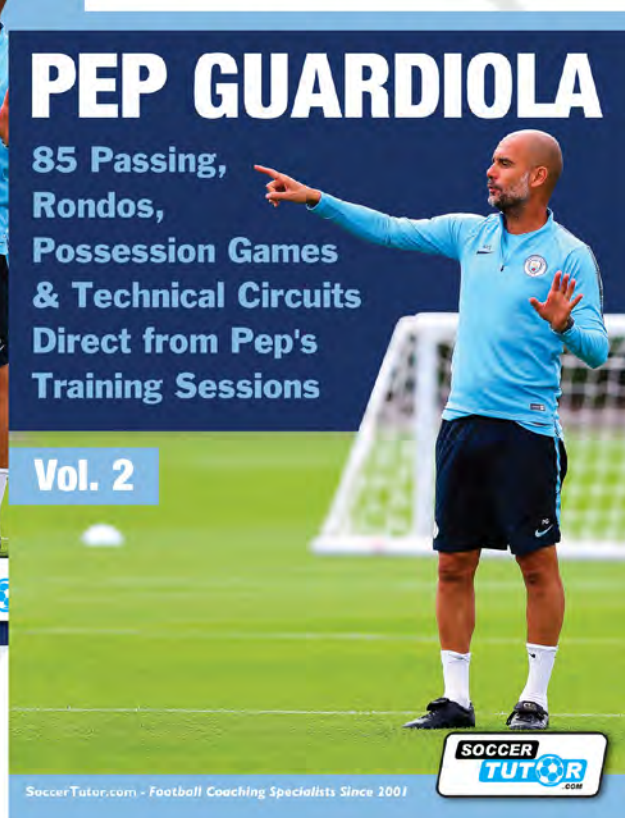
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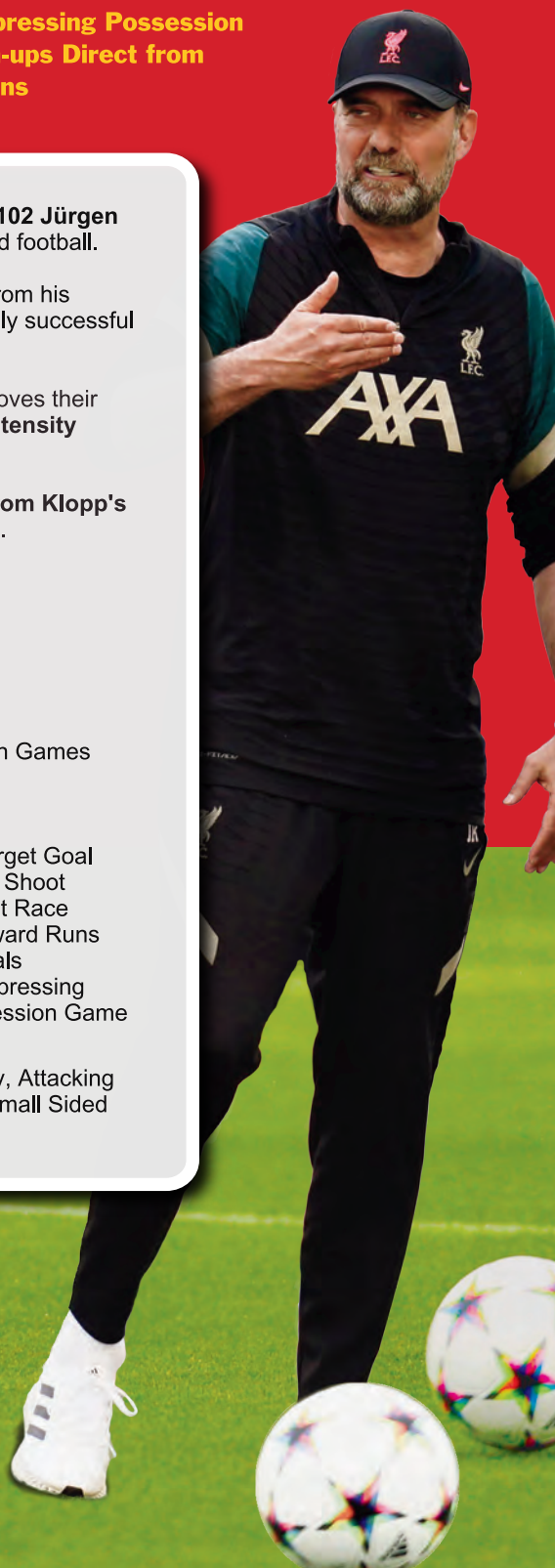
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